PRIMARY FIVE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Term One | Week Two | Lesson Three

THE PRESENT PERFECT PASSIVE

Topic: Tenses

What you will learn

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

1. Explain the meaning of the present perfect passive.
2. Identify the helping verbs used in the tense.
3. Change suitable present perfect sentences from active to passive.
4. Write correct present perfect passive sentences.

1. Meaning

The **present perfect passive** tells us that an action has been completed, but we give more attention to the person or thing receiving the action than to the person doing it.

Compare these two sentences:

- **Active:** The pupils have cleaned the classroom.
- **Passive:** The classroom has been cleaned by the pupils.

Both sentences describe the same completed action. In the passive sentence, *the classroom* comes first because it receives the action.

2. How to form the present perfect passive

Subject receiving the action + has/have + been + past participle (+ by + doer).

Subject	Helping verbs	Past participle	Rest of sentence
The gate	has been	painted	by the caretaker.
The books	have been	arranged	on the shelf.
Our classroom	has been	swept	this morning.
The mangoes	have been	picked	by the children.

Use **has been** with one person or thing: *the boy, the desk, she, it*.

Use **have been** with more than one person or thing and with *I, you, we, they*.

Remember: A passive sentence needs **been** before the past participle. We say *has been washed*, not *has washed* when the subject receives the action.

3. Active and passive sentences

In the active voice, the subject does the action. In the passive voice, the subject receives the action.

Active	Present perfect passive
Amina has washed the plates.	The plates have been washed by Amina.
The teacher has marked the books.	The books have been marked by the teacher.
The farmers have harvested the maize.	The maize has been harvested by the farmers.
The nurse has cleaned the room.	The room has been cleaned by the nurse.

Notice that **has/have** depends on the new subject, not on the person who did the action.

4. Positive, negative and question forms

Positive: The food has been cooked.

Negative: The food has not been cooked.

Question: Has the food been cooked?

Short answer: Yes, it has. / No, it has not.

With plural subjects:

- The uniforms have been washed.

- The uniforms have not been washed.

- Have the uniforms been washed?

- Yes, they have. / No, they have not.

5. When do we mention the doer?

We can add **by + doer** when it is important to say who did the action.

- The school garden has been watered **by the pupils**.

- The football has been found. (We do not know or need to say who found it.)

6. Common mistakes and corrections

Incorrect	Correct
The door has painted.	The door has been painted.
The desks has been cleaned.	The desks have been cleaned.
The letter have been written.	The letter has been written.
The eggs have been ate.	The eggs have been eaten.
The room has been clean.	The room has been cleaned.

7. Worked examples

Example A. Change to passive: The gardener has cut the grass.

The object *the grass* becomes the new subject. Use *has been* because *grass* is treated as singular. The past participle of *cut* is *cut*.

Answer: The grass has been cut by the gardener.

Example B. Complete: The oranges _____ _____ _____ (sell).

The oranges are plural, so use *have been*. The past participle of *sell* is *sold*.

Answer: The oranges **have been sold**.

Example C. Make a question: The chairs have been repaired.

Move *have* before the subject.

Answer: Have the chairs been repaired?

EXERCISE

Write neatly. Use has been or have been and the correct past participle.

A. Complete the sentences.

1. The classroom _____ _____ _____ (sweep).

_____

2. The bananas _____ _____ _____ (sell).

_____

3. Our school flag _____ _____ _____ (raise).

_____

4. The letters _____ _____ _____ (write).

_____

5. The broken chair _____ _____ _____ (repair).

_____

6. The plates _____ _____ _____ (wash).

_____

7. The rice _____ _____ _____ (cook).

_____

8. The goats _____ _____ _____ (feed).

_____

B. Change these active sentences into the present perfect passive.

9. The head teacher has opened the library.

_____

_____

10. The pupils have planted the trees.

_____

_____

11. Musa has broken the window.

_____

_____

12. The cook has prepared lunch.

_____

_____

13. The farmers have harvested the beans.

_____

_____

14. The shopkeeper has counted the coins.

_____

_____

C. Correct each mistake.

15. The desks has been arranged.

_____

16. The book has been wrote.

_____

17. The compound have been swept.

_____

18. The mangoes have picked.

_____

19. The door has been open by the guard.

_____

20. The balls have been took away.

_____

D. Change the sentence as instructed.

21. The water has been boiled. (Make negative.)

_____

22. The bags have been packed. (Make a question.)

_____

23. The wall has been painted. (Make a question.)

_____

24. The papers have not been collected. (Make positive.)

_____

E. Write your own sentences.

25. Write one present perfect passive sentence with **has been**.

_____

_____

26. Write one present perfect passive sentence with **have been**.

_____

_____

Remember

- The passive subject **receives** the action.
- Use **has/have + been + past participle**.
- Use **has been** with a singular subject and **have been** with a plural subject.
- Add **by + doer** only when it is useful.